

Problem 5. Maonan (25 marks)

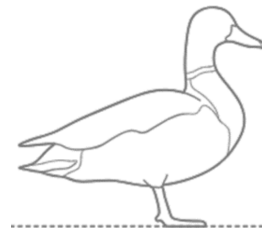
Maonan is a Kra-Dai language spoken by around 75,000 people in the border area of Guangxi and Guizhou provinces of China. They refer to themselves as **kjəŋ⁵na:n⁶** *Maonan people*.

Below are some words and phrases in Maonan, written in a simplified phonetic transcription, with their English translations given in a random order.

Note that *pheasants* and *mallards* are species of wild birds, pictured below. Male/female chickens, pigs, and buffalo are referred to as *roosters/hens*, *boars/sows*, and *bulls/cows* respectively. *Molars* are the largest teeth, found at the back of the mouth. *Tears* here refer to the clear liquid released when crying. *Water sprayers* are tools for spraying water, for example onto plants. **a:i**, **a:**, **i:u**, **ɛ**, and **ə** are vowels; **ɲ**, **ŋ** and **ʔ** are consonants. Raised numbers such as ¹ indicate the tone of the preceding syllable.



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|--|-------------------------------|
| 1. da:i²na⁴ | A. <i>bad chicken</i> |
| 2. dat⁸na⁴ | B. <i>big pig</i> |
| 3. dat⁸tan³ | C. <i>buffalo bull</i> |
| 4. dat⁸put⁷nam³ | D. <i>clothing</i> |
| 5. də²gjuŋ² | E. <i>delicious</i> |
| 6. də²ka:i⁵na:m¹ | F. <i>to eat resolutely</i> |
| 7. də²mu⁵ni⁴ | G. <i>elephant</i> |
| 8. hi:u³gwi² | H. <i>food</i> |
| 9. kjəŋ⁵hi:u³da:i² | I. <i>good teeth</i> |
| 10. kjəŋ⁵ka:i⁵ni⁴ | J. <i>grasshopper</i> |
| 11. na⁴nək⁸ | K. <i>jealous person</i> |
| 12. nam³nda¹ | L. <i>red mallard</i> |
| 13. ni⁴dzja:ŋ⁴ | M. <i>Maonan person</i> |
| 14. ni⁴gwi²dak⁸ | N. <i>molar</i> |
| 15. ni⁴mu⁵ | O. <i>pheasant</i> |
| 16. nək⁸ka:i⁵ | P. <i>hens</i> |
| 17. nək⁸ʔɛp⁷la:n³ | Q. <i>sow</i> |
| 18. put⁷pək⁸ | R. <i>to spray resolutely</i> |
| 19. ʔai¹na:n⁶ | S. <i>tear</i> |
| 20. ʔai¹nda¹la:n³ | T. <i>water sprayer</i> |

*pheasant**mallard*

(continued on the next page)

Q 5.1 Determine the correct correspondences.

Q 5.2 Translate into English:

21. **kjəŋ⁵mu⁵dak⁸**

22. **nda¹da:i²**

23. **tan³tək⁸**

24. **na:m¹tan³**

Q 5.3 Translate into Maonan:

25. *eyes*

26. *to spray*

27. *buffalo cows*

28. *domestic/farmyard duck*

29. *wearer*

Q 5.4 The Maonan phrase **gjuŋ²na⁴nam³** means *rainbow*. What is its literal translation?

Q 5.5 In a Maonan village, you see both **də²ŋa:n⁶** and **nək⁸ŋa:n⁶**. What is the difference between them? Suggest a possible English translation for **nək⁸ŋa:n⁶**.

Q 5.6 Explain your solution.